

STAGE NINE • ENGLISH VOCABULARY FIRST SET

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Nine • English Vocabulary First Set

PURPOSE

Stage Nine leans unusually heavily on live, spoken practice — games, drills, simulations — which makes format adaptation especially important here. Several activities genuinely translate well to video calls (typing-based games, hot-seat questioning); a few need real adjustment to preserve their energy and pacing.

This document covers every activity across Stage Nine's Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that changes shape between formats.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Circle Association Drill (FIRST M1)	A genuine physical circle; energy carries around the room naturally.	Use “speak in gallery view order” or call on names directly rather than open-floor, since a physical circle's natural turn-taking doesn't exist on video. Keep the pace brisk to preserve the game's energy.
Email Dictation Relay (FIRST M5)	Partner B writes by hand or on a shared notepad while Partner A speaks nearby.	Partner B types in a shared doc or the chat while Partner A speaks over the call; this works naturally well online since typing while listening is a normal video-call skill already.
Idiom Matching Game (FIRST M9)	Physical cards, or index cards, raced against another group.	Use a shared, timed digital matching activity (a simple slide with draggable text boxes, or a quiz tool) rather than physical cards. Breakout rooms of 3–4 per group, reconvened to compare times.
Fishbowl Meeting Simulation (FIRST M16) / Negotiation (FIRST M17)	Volunteers in a visible inner circle; observers surround them.	Volunteers turn cameras on; use “spotlight” so their video tiles are prominent. Everyone else stays muted, cameras optional, watching via chat-based observation notes.
Hot Seat (FIRST M24) / Surprise Question Gauntlet (FIRST M30)	Volunteer sits at the front; questions come rapid-fire from the room.	Works naturally well online — questions can come via unmuting or via chat read aloud by the facilitator for pacing control, which can actually improve fairness in question order.
Rapid-Fire Openers (FIRST M26)	Participants stand and deliver in sequence at the front of the room.	Call on participants in a set order to avoid dead air; consider muting everyone except the current speaker to keep transitions crisp.
Live Generative Round (FIRST M36)	Small groups clustered together, visibly building energy off each other.	Breakout rooms of 3–4; the “reset on evaluation” rule works even better online since a facilitator or co-host can visit rooms briefly to enforce it playfully.
Growth Circle (FIRST M37)	A genuine physical circle for the closing share.	Use “raise hand” or call names directly from a list; this closing activity benefits from cameras on if participants are comfortable, since it's a warmer, more personal moment than most of the stage.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For live speaking drills specifically, a hybrid format should avoid mixing in-person and remote participants within the same small group where possible — audio quality differences make

rapid back-and-forth practice (like the Hot Seat or negotiation role-plays) genuinely harder across that divide.

Games with a competitive or timed element (the Idiom Matching Game, the brainstorming reset rule) need a single shared clock visible to both in-person and remote participants — a shared timer on screen works better than a facilitator calling time verbally, which remote participants may not hear clearly.